

Pretrial Services Agency (PSA)

Response to Questions

CMS Next Generation

SOL# 959P0025Q0017

Proposal due extended to 1PM (EST), September 18, 2025

QUESTION #1: Is there an incumbent on this contract? If so, please provide the incumbent name, current contract number, Period of performance, Value of the contract?

PSA RESPONSE: This is a new requirement. Currently, there are no vendors under contract for the PWS.

QUESTION #2: Would you kindly confirm if this is an entirely new effort or is there an incumbent currently providing these services? If so, would you please provide the incumbent contract details?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #1.

QUESTION #3: What will be the contract value for this opportunity?

PSA RESPONSE: The independent government estimate (IGE) will not be disclosed. The actual contract value will not be determined until the contract award.

QUESTION #4: Does PSA want MFA via Azure AD, PIV cards, or hybrid?

PSA RESPONSE: The MFA solution will be hybrid. The MFA solution must allow partner agencies access to the system.

QUESTION #5: What does the government consider the most critical aspects of responsible AI tenants, e.g., explainability, transparency, fairness?

PSA RESPONSE: The most critical aspects considered are Privacy & Security, Accountability & Governance, Data Protection, Human-centered design and Transparency.

QUESTION #6: In the PWS, the government references capturing addresses is a major pain point. Beyond this, are there any additional specific and major user pain points or workflows that PSA identified and would like the vendor to focus on during the initial discovery phase?

PSA RESPONSE: Requirements and pain points are detailed in the CMS Modernization Project – PRISM Functional Requirements document.

QUESTION #7: Are there any page count requirements that you can share for each respective volume?

PSA RESPONSE: Each section in Volume 1, not to exceed 5 pages. Volume 2 past performance not exceed 5 pages. Volume 2 no page limits on the resumes.

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QUESTION #8: Access to Existing Systems: Will we have access to the legacy PRISM source code and database design?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes. The contractor will have access to legacy PRISM source code and database design.

QUESTION #9: Infrastructure Details: What are the specifications for the "existing Azure commercial infrastructure"? such as the specific Azure services being used, resource groups, and network topology to ensure seamless integration.

PSA RESPONSE: The existing Azure infrastructure is architected as a hub and spoke model with multiple subscriptions (dev/test/prod) separated by resource group. Virtual machines are deployed in the front and backend.

QUESTION #10: Development Tools: What specific development tools and technologies are approved for use beyond the high-level mentions of .NET Core and ServiceStack?

PSA RESPONSE: The government will review contractor recommendations for development tools and other related technology solutions.

QUESTION #11: Data Migration Plan: Is there a data migration plan? A modernization of this scale requires a strategy for migrating data from the legacy MS SQL Server database to the new Azure-hosted database.

PSA RESPONSE: The legacy MS SQL Server is currently hosted in a stretched cluster in Azure. Data migration will be a side-by-side until all new modules are developed. Once all modules are developed a full data migration plan will be developed, reviewed and approved by the government for implementation.

QUESTION #12: Consumption Costs: We need information about expected traffic, such as the number of concurrent users, the average number of API calls per user, and the data transfer volume.

PSA RESPONSE: This information will be uncovered during the discovery.

QUESTION #13: Security Tools and Requirements: The PWS mentions security audits, web application scans, and penetration tests. What specific tools and configurations are required for these tasks?

PSA RESPONSE: The government will supply vulnerability scan results using existing tools. The contractor must perform security audits and penetration tests. The contractor must provide the testing tools and plan for performing penetration testing. The contractor must recommend tools for performing web application scans and security audits.

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QUESTION #14: Is this a recompete/follow-on of an existing contract? If so, what is the contract number, period of performance, and total contract value?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #1

QUESTION #15: If there is an incumbent contractor, has the scope or size of the contract changed in any nontrivial way between the incumbent contract and the present solicitation?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #1

QUESTION #16: If there is no incumbent contractor, then are there existing contractor(s) that are doing some of the work of this PWS? If so, what are their name(s) and contract number(s)?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #1

QUESTION #17: If the work of the PWS is not being done at all right now, then is there a backlog that the incoming contractor will have to handle? If so, please explain and describe how much of a backlog there is.

PSA RESPONSE: No

QUESTION #18: If there is an incumbent contract, is the scope and estimated workload for the present solicitation approximately the same as for the incumbent contract?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #1

QUESTION #19: Is this contract a complete re-implementation/re-factorization of the existing CMS applications, as the PWS makes it appear? Or is this contract merely a recompetete where the incoming contractor will take over O&M responsibility for the existing CMS systems and incrementally modernize them over a period of time?

PSA RESPONSE: The contract effort is to build a new system. The new system must have backward compatibility. The contractor is not responsible for O&M of the existing system.

QUESTION #20: It seems some of the applications that make up CMS are already modernized. As just one example of this, PWS 4.1.3 (p. 6) states, "The Drug Testing Management System version 3.0 has proven to be reliable and has continuously delivered quality services since its inception in February 2019. The system has already been refactored to handle an extremely high number of substances per test and to utilize modern web technologies. DTMS sends and receives data to and from PRISM on a regular basis." This makes DTMS sound fully modernized and that no additional modernization work is needed. Can the Government list each component of CMS (i.e., PWS 4.1 and

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4.2), perhaps via a table, and give the status of each component and tell what the Government wants done with each component? Whether full modernization/refactoring, or UI/UX improvements, or migration from on-premises to cloud?

PSA RESPONSE: Reference the PWS and the CMS Modernization Project – PRISM Functional Requirements document to determine the required areas for system modernization.

QUESTION #21: What are the Government's targets for modernization timeframes and release schedule for each component of CMS?

PSA RESPONSE: The timeframes for modernization tasks are detailed in the 'key project tasks' section and 'deliverables' table included in the PWS.

QUESTION #22: What are the specific goals for the modernization? (example: upgrade the UI/UX, migrate to cloud, align with the U.S. Digital Playbook, etc.)

PSA RESPONSE: Reference the PWS.

QUESTION #23: What are specific shortcomings of the legacy/current CMS system and environment which the Government wishes to address with the modernization?

PSA RESPONSE: The CMS Modernization Project – PRISM Functional Requirements document details the modernization of the functional components of the system. User interface and user experience requirements are addressed in the PWS.

QUESTION #24: Would the government please provide incumbent contractor details, if available?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #1

QUESTION #25: Would the government clarify whether offeror proposed key personnel resumes are required rather than resumes for every labor category proposed?

PSA RESPONSE: Resumes are required for key personnel.

QUESTION #26: Would the government please clarify page limitations for each volume?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #7

QUESTION #27: Would the government please extend the proposal due date by one week to allow offerors time to respond accordingly to subsequent Amendments?

PSA RESPONSE: If a proposal submission date is extended, it will be indicated by an amendment to the solicitation.

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QUESTION #28: There is reference to "CMS Modernization Project: PRISM Functional Requirements" in the acquisition package, but the document seems to be missing. Please ensure the acquisition package has this document.

PSA RESPONSE: Document is attached to the amendment.

QUESTION #29: "The PWS has the following requirement.

The contractor must comply with the following agency policies:

PS1008 Records and Information Management

PS4060 Personnel Security Program

PS5000 Information Technology Security Program

PS5002 Safeguarding PII

PS5336 Acceptable Use Policy

PS5335 Prohibition of Network Access and GFE use outside of the United States

PS5510 Electronic and Information Technology Accessibility (508 Compliance)

Can PSA-DC please make these policies available as part of the solicitation package?"

PSA RESPONSE: The PSA policies are in full context in the solicitation documentation.

QUESTION #30: "Section L is asking vendors to submit 3 past experiences and Section M is requesting 2 past experiences. Can the government clarify if vendors have to submit 2 or 3 past experiences?"

PSA RESPONSE: The Offeror must provide two past experiences from similar work performed in the past five years.

QUESTION #31: Can the government provide instruction on page limits for proposal submission for the following?

1. Volume 1 - Technical Proposal - Capabilities

A: Technical Approach and Management Approach

B: Technical Expertise and Organizational Experience

2. Volume II - Past Performance

Resumes

PSA RESPONSE: Response for each section in volume 1 must not exceed 5 pages. Responses for Volume 2 past performance must not exceed 5 pages. There are no page limits for the Volume 2 resumes.

QUESTION #32: Can the government provide more details on the current cloud environment?

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PSA RESPONSE: See response to question #9.

QUESTION #33: Can the government share SLA's around application performance?

PSA RESPONSE: The agency operates 24x7 therefore the system must always be available. Every page must load within two seconds. Additional performance specifications will be shared in the discovery phase.

QUESTION #34: Could you please advise the Key Personnel for this RFP?

PSA RESPONSE: Key personnel include the Program Manager, IT Solutions Engineer, Network Architect, IT Security Architect, Software Developers and Cloud Engineers

QUESTION #35: Please advise if we need to include the resumes for: IT Solutions Engineer, Network Architect, IT Security Architect, Software Developers, and Cloud Engineers?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes. The Offeror must include resumes for the Program Manager, IT Solutions Engineer, Network Architect, IT Security Architect, Software Developers and Cloud Engineers

QUESTION #36: If there is no incumbent contractor, then are there existing contractor(s) that are doing some of the work of this PWS? If so, what are their name(s) and contract number(s)?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #1

QUESTION #37: Per RFP Section M, the basis for award is stated as Lowest Price Technically Acceptable (LPTA), but the evaluation description includes tradeoff language (e.g., awarding to a higher-priced offer if non-price factors justify it). Can the Government clarify if the award will strictly follow LPTA (with non-price factors as pass/fail) or a Best Value Tradeoff approach, and what are the minimum technical acceptability thresholds (e.g., compliance with all functional requirements in PWS Section 10 versus demonstrated experience with comparable modernization)?

PSA RESPONSE: The award basis is Lowest Price Technically Acceptable (LPTA). Proposals will be evaluated for acceptability based on established technical standards. Only proposals that meet the technical standards will be considered for lowest price evaluation. This will not be a Best Value Tradeoff Approach award basis.

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QUESTION #38: Per RFP Section M, Factor 3 (Past Performance), is PSA prioritizing experience with justice/court systems, risk-based supervision (as in PWS Section 2), or general large- scale case management modernization in evaluating relevance? Additionally, can the Government clarify the minimum number of references required (e.g., "minimum 3" per Section L versus "at least two (2)" per Section M)?

PSA RESPONSE: The government will assess past performance based upon the responses to the questionnaire and references provided for projects of similar scope and complexity. The Offeror must provide at least two past experience references from projects of similar scope and complexity performed in the past five years.

QUESTION #39: Per RFP Section M, Factor 1 (Technical Approach), will offerors be evaluated on their proposed approach to human-centered design (HCD per PWS Section 4) and phased modernization (PWS Section 3)? How do the evaluation factors (technical approach, expertise, past performance, price) compare in relative importance, as listed in order in Section M?

PSA RESPONSE: The Offeror response will be evaluated on approach for both human centered design and modernization. The technical and management approach, technical expertise and organizational experience and past performance are weighted factors. Price is a consideration but not a deciding factor.

QUESTION #40: Per RFP Section L, can the Government confirm if the Past Performance Questionnaire (Attachment B or C) must be used for all references, and if offerors can submit additional narratives to supplement the ratings (e.g., on quality, schedule, cost control)?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes. The questionnaire must be used for all references. The Offeror may supplement the questionnaire with a narrative.

QUESTION #41: Can PSA clarify the list of external justice partners that the modernized CMS must integrate with?

PSA RESPONSE: The new system must exchanges information with local and Federal law enforcement agencies and justice partners, such as DC Metropolitan Police Department, DC Superior Court, US District Court for DC, US Attorney's Office, DC Office of Attorney General, Federal Bureau of Investigation, US Marshals, and the Criminal Justice Coordinating Council (CJCC). The complete list will be confirmed in the discovery phase.

QUESTION #42: Are there data sharing agreements already established for those external justice partners?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes. Data sharing agreements are in place with justice partners.

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QUESTION #43: Per PWS Section 14.2, can the Government provide the current system integration documentation (interfaces, data schemas, APIs) for PRISM, PRISMJ, and DTMS to support bridge development?

PSA RESPONSE: The Offeror must conduct a discovery. During the discovery task, the government will share with the contractor the specific details relative to integration documentation.

QUESTION #44: Will incumbents provide knowledge transfer support during the transition to ensure continuity?

PSA RESPONSE: This is a new project. No incumbents exist.

QUESTION #45: For each phase, is there a required parallel operations period before decommissioning legacy functionality, or will PSA accept a cutover approach once new features are validated?

PSA RESPONSE: Parallel operation is required until the final acceptance of the project deliverables.

QUESTION #46: Per PWS Section 10, will the Government provide access to legacy source code and database schemas during the discovery phase (PWS Section 9.1), or is the contractor responsible for reverse-engineering to ensure coexistence with legacy CMS?

PSA RESPONSE: The contractor will be provided access to the Azure environment, legacy source code and database schemas during the discovery phase.

QUESTION #47: Are contractors expected to provision and manage Azure resources, or will PSA provide all cloud hosting?

PSA RESPONSE: PSA will provide a development and test environment in Azure. Shared tenancy will limit some access that contractors have to manage Azure resources. The contractor may be required to recommend a solution/configuration then work alongside the government to implement the approved.

QUESTION #48: Per PWS Section 9.4 on data acquisition, will the Government provide cleansed historical PRISM data, or is the contractor responsible for data profiling, cleansing, and transformation?

PSA RESPONSE: The government will provide historical PRISM data. The contractor is not responsible for data profiling or transformation.

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QUESTION #49: Can the Government clarify expectations for AI/analytics referenced in the objectives? Specifically:

PSA RESPONSE: The Agency is in the early stages of AI adoption. Any AI recommendation must be both flexible and scalable and factor in the responses in question #5.

QUESTION #50: Are machine learning models expected to be delivered as part of the solution?

PSA RESPONSE: No. Machine learning models are not expected as part of this project.

QUESTION #51: Will PSA provide existing datasets for model training?

PSA RESPONSE: See response under question #50

QUESTION #52: Per PWS Section 8.4, must contractors use Azure DevOps exclusively for project management, CI/CD, and testing, or can alternative tools be proposed if integrated with Azure?

PSA RESPONSE: Alternative tools can be proposed for the Government to consider and approve.

QUESTION #53: Is the contractor required to propose or identify a specific management platform (e.g., Okta, Azure) as part of the solution?

PSA RESPONSE: See response provided in question #52

QUESTION #54: Will the Government provide details on the current data volume and structure in PRISM for scoping data migration efforts?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes. This will be part of the discovery phase.

QUESTION #55: Per PWS Sections 7 and 9.5, the PWS requires compliance with NIST, FISMA, and Zero Trust principles. Can PSA clarify whether the new CMS must achieve a formal Authority to Operate (ATO) under FedRAMP/FISMA prior to production release in each phase?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes.

QUESTION #56: Will PSA's security team provide boundary definitions and inherited controls for Azure- hosted environments?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes

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QUESTION #57: For PII and criminal history data, does PSA require encryption at rest and in transit only, or also field-level encryption/tokenization?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes. Encryption is required for data at rest, data in transit and sensitive data. The contractor must recommend data protection commensurate with the sensitivity of the system and the security objectives.

QUESTION #58: Per PWS Section 4.3, will PSA provide direct access to stakeholder groups (judges, Pretrial Services Officers, drug testing technicians, attorneys, etc.) for user research and design validation?

PSA RESPONSE: Access to external stakeholder groups will be prioritized and discussed if the situation is encountered. *will be discussed with stakeholders if the situation is encountered.*

QUESTION #59: Can the Government provide standard templates for reports and deliverables (e.g., Project Plans, Risk Registers, Training Materials), or should contractors propose formats?

PSA RESPONSE: Contractor must propose formats based on any current templates that exist

QUESTION #60: Per PWS Section 12, what are the acceptance criteria for each deliverable (e.g., formal review board approval, user acceptance testing per Section 9.4)?

PSA RESPONSE: The acceptance criteria will be provided in the Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan.

QUESTION #61: Original (Okay): For training deliverables, does PSA expect in-person training sessions at headquarters, train-the-trainer models, or web-based training materials only?

PSA RESPONSE: A combination of training formats and modalities dependent on the content and audience.

QUESTION #62: Per PWS Section 14.5, the PWS specifies contractor personnel must be U.S. citizens and obtain Public Trust clearance. Can PSA provide expected average clearance processing times?

PSA RESPONSE: The process can be as long as four weeks.

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QUESTION #63: Will interim access be permitted during the clearance process to avoid project delays?

PSA RESPONSE: No

QUESTION #64: Per PWS Sections 9.7 and 14.3, the PWS references PSA policies on records and data ownership. Can PSA clarify whether contractor-developed intellectual property (e.g., proprietary frameworks or tools) will be treated as government-owned deliverables, or whether contractors may retain rights to reusable components?

PSA RESPONSE: Government owned deliverables

QUESTION #65: Per PWS Section 14.2, can the Government clarify minimum qualifications for key personnel roles (e.g., Program Manager, IT Security Architect) beyond the general requirements listed, such as exact certification preferences?

PSA RESPONSE: Reference the PWS

QUESTION #66: Per RFP Section M, Factor 2, will the Government consider offeror certifications (e.g., CMMI Level 3, Microsoft Gold Partner) as part of evaluating technical expertise and organizational experience?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes

QUESTION #67: Per RFP Section L, Volume III (Price Proposal), can the Government provide a template or example for submitting proposed labor categories, hourly rates, and estimated hours per phase to ensure consistency?

PSA RESPONSE: No

QUESTION #68: Does the Agency have any preference between an On-Premise vs. Hosted Solution?

PSA RESPONSE: Reference the PWS

QUESTION #69: Is this project funded? If so, what are the Capital and Operational budgets?

PSA RESPONSE: Budget details for this requirement will not be disclosed.

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QUESTION #70: What is the desired timeline for this project?

PSA RESPONSE: Reference the PWS

QUESTION #71: What are the total number of users?

PSA RESPONSE: This will be confirmed during the discovery phase.

QUESTION #72: What are the different types of users that will access the CMS system (i.e., Full, Partial, Read-Only).

PSA RESPONSE: This will be shared the discovery phase

QUESTION #73: Please provide an overview of all the different stakeholders that have access to the current CMS.

PSA RESPONSE: This will be shared the discovery phase

QUESTION #74: Please provide a list of current data exchanges that are used and if they are uni or bi-directional and what types of technology they use (SFTP, Web Services, REST APIs, etc.)

PSA RESPONSE: This will be shared the discovery phase

QUESTION #75: Please provide the tool currently used for reporting and data analysis.

PSA RESPONSE: This will be shared the discovery phase

QUESTION #76: Please provide an approximate count of the reports that are currently used.

PSA RESPONSE: This will be shared the discovery phase

QUESTION #77: Is the Agency seeking a Custom CMS or is it open to a Commercial Off-The-Shelf-System that is highly customizable?

PSA RESPONSE: Custom CMS

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QUESTION #78: What is the desired response format and checklist for this solicitation? Example, should responders provide details for each item in 4.3 CMS Modernization – PRISM Functional Requirements? Please provide all the sections needed for a COMPLETE response and in the order, they should be responded to so that it is understood to provide a complete response to this solicitation – including any required forms or if anything needs to be notarized.

PSA RESPONSE: No. The technical approach response must consider all aspects of the project as described in the PWS.

QUESTION #79: Can PSA clarify whether development/test Azure subscriptions and related software licenses will be Government Furnished?

PSA RESPONSE: Yes, Government furnished

QUESTION #80: Would PSA use a federal or state Acquisition vehicle to provide licensing for the proposed solution by the system integrator?

PSA RESPONSE: Federal acquisition vehicle

QUESTION #81: Can PSA confirm there is no page limitation for the technical volume response?

PSA RESPONSE: See response provided for question #7

QUESTION #82: Should past performance references be limited to prime contracts, or will subcontractor projects also be accepted?

PSA RESPONSE: The Offeror should make the determination on past performance references.

QUESTION #83: Will PSA accept electronic signatures on SF 1449 and Attachment B forms?

PSA RESPONSE: Electronic signatures to include a date will be acceptable.

QUESTION #84: The solicitation document (SF 1449, Block 8) lists the proposal due date as **September 15, 2025, at 1:00 PM EST**, while the posting on **SAM.gov** reflects **September 17, 1PM EST, 2025**. Can PSA please confirm the official due date and time for submission?

PSA RESPONSE: The proposal submittal date is extended to **September 18, 2025, at 1PM (EST)**.

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QUESTION #85: The PWS (Section 3, Scope) notes legacy PRISM must remain in production until all modernized functions are deployed. Can PSA clarify whether the contractor is responsible for full data migration from PRISM to the modernized CMS, and if so, what is the expected volume and format of data? Will sample datasets and schema documentation be provided prior to the contract award?

PSA RESPONSE: No sample datasets and schema documentation will not be provided prior to contract award. The Offeror must address data migration as part of the technical approach. The contractor must recommend a data migration plan for government review and approval. Upon approval, the contractor must work with the government to determine specific data migration tasks and responsible roles.

QUESTION #86: Section 7 cites multiple NIST standards (SP 800-53 Rev. 5, SP 800-218, Zero Trust principles). Can PSA clarify whether a full Authority to Operate (ATO) package is required under FISMA, or if the modernization will inherit an existing PSA ATO?

PSA RESPONSE: A full ATO package is required

QUESTION #87: Will contractors be required to provide vulnerability scanning and penetration testing as part of CMS development, or will PSA handle that under its enterprise security program?

PSA RESPONSE: See response to question #13

QUESTION #88: Are there specific UX accessibility benchmarks (e.g., WCAG 2.1 AA) required in addition to 508 compliances?

PSA RESPONSE: Reference to the CMS Modernization – PRISM Functional Requirements. Confirmations will be discussed in discovery phased.

QUESTION #89: For phased modernization (DTSC, CI/CH, RBS, TR, DRI), will PSA require parallel operations of legacy PRISM and new CMS modules for a defined stabilization period? If so, should contractors include dual system maintenance support in pricing?

PSA RESPONSE: No

QUESTION #90: The PWS describes interfaces with multiple external partners (e.g., DC Superior Court, MPD, FBI, CJCC). Can PSA provide the expected method of integration (API, batch file transfer, secure messaging) and confirm whether interface specifications will be Government Furnished or contractor-developed?

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PSA RESPONSE: This is part of the discovery phase.

QUESTION #91: The PWS references integration with Azure commercial infrastructure. Will PSA provide and manage the Azure environment (tenants, subscriptions, FedRAMP boundary), or is the contractor expected to stand up and manage this environment under PSA governance?

PSA RESPONSE: The government will provide the contractor access to the existing Azure environment. The government will provide the contractor a dev/test subscription to build and test the new system. The contractor must work with the government to configure and manage the new Azure environment. Some roles, services and management functions may be unavailable to the contractor due to shared tenancy and zero trust security.

QUESTION #92: Is PSA requiring deployment in Azure Government (GovCloud) for compliance, or will Azure Commercial be acceptable?

PSA RESPONSE: The current environment compliance is GCC high. The contractor must design security for GCC high with consideration being given for protecting CUI and sensitive data.

QUESTION #93: Please confirm that the recent relevant contracts time frame is 5 years (Section M, Factor Past Performance).

PSA RESPONSE: Yes. Past performance should cover last five years.

QUESTION #94: Will the government define which roles are designated as key? As the PWS and RFP seemed to state that are contractors to support the work must have a resume submitted with the proposal.

PSA RESPONSE: See the response to questions #34 and #35.